

Information Systems & Organization

VINTED

STUDENT:

AOUAD Perla

MAYA ROSERO Manuel David

PROFESSOR:

ISAAC Henri

January, 2026

Paris – France

Table of Contents

0. Executive summary.....	2
1. Introduction.....	2
1.1 Why Vinted, why circular platforms now.....	2
1.2 Problematic.....	3
1.3 Method: platform analysis + scenario planning + regulation scan.....	3
2. Vinted today: platform model & value creation.....	3
2.1 Platform scope and core services.....	3
2.2 Business model and monetization levers.....	4
2.3 Data as a resource and network effects.....	5
2.4 Governance and trust today.....	5
2.5 Performance signals and trajectory.....	6
3. What changes with agentic AI.....	6
3.1 Definition: agentic means act, negotiate, transact.....	6
3.2 Where agents enter the value chain.....	7
3.3 Why this threatens or strengthens the platform.....	7
4. Future scenarios.....	8
4.1 Scenario A - AI Augmented Vinted.....	8
4.2 Scenario B - Open Agent Ecosystem.....	8
4.3 Scenario C - Protocolized Re-commerce.....	9
4.4 Scenario D - Fragmented Gray Market.....	9
5. Trust, traceability, and the Digital Product Passport.....	10
5.1 The DPP as a “trust substrate” for recommerce.....	10
5.2 How agentic AI consumes and produces trust signals.....	11
5.3 Where blockchain helps and where it doesn’t.....	13
6. Regulation and ethical challenges in Europe.....	13
6.1 Digital Services Act: marketplace duties, transparency, and scalable harms.....	13
6.2 EU AI Act: accountability by role (provider vs deployer) and agentic decision risks..	14
6.3. Data Act and Data Governance Act: interoperability, access rules, and “data sovereignty”.....	15
6.4. Competition boundary condition: DMA and gatekeeper layers.....	15
7. Critical conclusion.....	16
7.1. Most plausible 2030 scenario in Europe.....	16
7.2 Strategic recommendations for Vinted.....	17
7.3. Final position.....	18
8. Appendix - Use of GenAI log.....	18
8.1 Tools and models used.....	18
8.2 Purpose and scope of GenAI use.....	18
8.3 Principal prompts used.....	18
8.4 What was accepted vs. what was rejected/edited.....	19
8.5 Verification and quality-control approach.....	20
8.6 Student vs. AI role delineation.....	20
Références.....	21

0. Executive summary

Vinted is a European C2C recommerce platform that scales buyer-seller matching, reduces transaction frictions, and sustains trust through payments, buyer protection, dispute resolution, and moderation, consistent with two-sided market and network-effect dynamics [5][9]. Recommerce demand is reinforced by price sensitivity, sustainability narratives, and identity motives [6][8].

This paper examines how agentic AI, autonomous agents able to act, negotiate, and transact, could shift Vinted's coordinating role in the value chain [10][14]. Drawing on platform ecosystem theory, we contrast two trajectories: consolidation, where Vinted integrates agents into its trust and infrastructure stack; and partial disintermediation, where buyer and seller agents transact across interoperable rails and complementary services beyond one platform [3][7].

We combine a platform-model diagnosis, a 2×2 scenario analysis centered on centralization versus decentralization and trust-infrastructure ownership, and a regulatory scan focused on EU traceability and standardized trust signals, including the Digital Product Passport logic under the ESPR [11][12].

The four scenarios are summarized in the 2×2 matrix in Section 4 (Figure 2)

1. Introduction

1.1 Why Vinted, why circular platforms now

Second-hand consumption has moved from a marginal practice to a mainstream digital behavior. Research on collaborative and access-based consumption shows that platforms can scale non-ownership practices by lowering search costs, standardizing interactions, and reframing norms around access, value, and sustainability [1][2]. In recommerce specifically, motivations combine economic drivers (price, budget constraints), functional convenience (availability and variety), and symbolic or ethical dimensions (anti-waste, identity, smart consumption) [8]. Vinted is a strong case because it sits at the intersection of platform economics (two-sided matching and network effects), trust-intensive transactions (condition uncertainty, counterfeits, disputes, delivery proof), and growing European regulatory pressure on marketplaces and data-driven systems [5][9]. At the ecosystem level, platforms must balance openness (innovation, growth) with control (quality, trust, monetization) [3][7]. Vinted is also timely because it is mature enough that strategy increasingly depends on institutionalizing infrastructure such as payments, logistics, and trust rails, which makes it an ideal site to study how agentic AI could reshape coordination in recommerce [13][14].

1.2 Problematic

How will agentic AI reshape value creation and governance in Vinted's recommerce platform: by reinforcing platform centralization through embedded agent infrastructures, or by enabling decentralized agent-to-agent exchanges that partially disintermediate the platform? [\[3\]\[5\]\[10\]](#)

1.3 Method: platform analysis + scenario planning + regulation scan

We adopt a mixed analytical approach aligned with platform studies and the course perspective on the evolution from platforms to agentic organization [\[5\]\[14\]](#):

Platform-model diagnosis (today): scope, monetization levers, data and network effects, and governance mechanisms for trust and dispute resolution [\[5\]\[9\]](#).

Agentic AI impact analysis: We define agentic AI through multi-agent systems logic (agents that act, negotiate, and coordinate), then identify where agents could intervene in the value chain (buyer/seller/platform/compliance agents) and what this implies for control, data, and trust [\[10\]\[14\]](#).

Regulation scan (EU lens): We map how EU rules shape feasible designs for platforms and agentic systems, especially around traceability (ESPR/DPP), accountability, transparency, and data governance [\[11\]\[12\]](#).

2. Vinted today: platform model & value creation

2.1 Platform scope and core services

We analyze Vinted as a multi-sided platform that coordinates exchanges between buyers and sellers. In platform terms, its role is not only to match supply and demand, but also to structure interactions through rules, interfaces, and complementary services that reduce transaction costs (search, communication, settlement, delivery integration, and conflict resolution) [\[5\]\[9\]](#).

In recommerce, coordination is especially demanding because product condition is uncertain, items are heterogeneous, and disputes are frequent compared with standardized retail. This means the “platform core” (listing, search, messaging, ranking) must be coupled with governance mechanisms (rules, moderation, dispute handling) and with operational complements (payments and logistics integration) to keep exchanges fluid at scale [\[7\]](#).

2.2 Business model and monetization levers

In two-sided markets, monetization is a pricing and governance strategy that must balance participation on both sides while preserving liquidity [9]. For Vinted, two generic levers capture most of the model:

- 1. Transaction-linked monetization bundled with trust services:** Marketplaces capture value by lowering perceived risk through protection logic, customer-support processes, and standardized dispute handling. Conceptually, this is “trust monetization”: users accept fees because the platform makes exchange safer and more repeatable [5][9].
- 2. Attention and visibility monetization:** Paid visibility tools monetize ranking space inside discovery. Sellers pay to reduce search friction and improve sell-through probability, turning attention allocation into an internal market governed by platform rules [7].

Layer	What the platform provides	How value can be captured	Governance lever (control)	Why it matters for agentic AI later
Marketplace matching	Search, ranking, recommendations, messaging	Indirectly (drives conversion & retention)	Ranking rules; content standards; anti-spam	Agents will optimize exposure + negotiation at scale
Transaction protection	Protection logic + claims handling + refunds	Transaction-linked fees / service charges	Evidence requirements; refund rules; enforcement	Agents can automate disputes → pressure on fairness & auditability
Payments & settlement	Checkout, holding/release logic, payouts	Service margin; increased lock-in	KYC/AML constraints; payout conditions	Agents need stable rails and compliance logic
Logistics integration	Labels, tracking, delivery options via partners	Margin on shipping services; retention	Proof-of-delivery logic; carrier integration rules	Agents will rely on tracking signals for dispute automation
Visibility tools	Promotional features for seller exposure	Paid visibility	Allocation of attention / ranking boosts	Seller agents may “bid” for attention continuously
Trust & moderation	Fraud controls, counterfeit mitigation, community rules	Indirect (protects liquidity)	Account sanctions; listing removals; risk scoring	Compliance agents become central; liability issues rise

Table 1 - Revenue model & governance levers

2.3 Data as a resource and network effects

Vinted's growth logic is driven by cross-side network effects: more sellers increase variety and match probability for buyers, while more buyers increase expected sell-through for sellers [9]. These feedback loops generate cumulative advantage, especially if the platform can keep transaction quality high through governance [5]. Data strengthens this dynamic. Behavioral traces (search, clicks, conversions, disputes, delivery outcomes) improve ranking and risk controls, which increases match quality and reduces uncertainty [5][7].

However, openness versus control remains central. More openness can expand participation and complement innovation, but it raises governance costs and quality risks. This trade-off is acute in recommerce because fraud and misrepresentation are structurally easier, making governance capacity a competitive asset rather than a back-office function [3][7].

2.4 Governance and trust today

Because second-hand transactions involve uncertainty (condition, authenticity, delivery), recommerce platforms must act as trust institutions rather than neutral intermediaries. Governance mechanisms, meaning rules, monitoring, dispute procedures, and enforcement, are central to sustaining liquidity [5]. Operationally, Vinted relies on Trust and Safety or moderation capabilities and standardized dispute-resolution procedures embedded in the workflow (reporting, evidence requirements, escalation, sanctions) [5][15].

We can summarize this as a layered trust stack:

- Ex ante signals (profiles, reputation cues, listing information),
- Transaction safeguards (protection logic, settlement and delivery proofs), and
- Ex post resolution (complaints processing, refunds, sanctions).

This aligns with the idea that platforms are market designers that standardize how quality is signaled and how conflicts are resolved [5][9]. The sustainability narrative should also be treated critically. While recommerce is often associated with circular economy claims, research shows that second-hand platform activity can produce rebound or backfire effects, depending on how it changes consumption frequency and turnover [6].

2.5 Performance signals and trajectory

For this paper, the key performance point is not an exact metric but a strategic implication: Vinted reported a profitability milestone in its 2023 results, signalling a shift from pure marketplace scaling toward consolidating and investing in trust and coordination infrastructure [13]. This matters for agentic AI because integration is not

just a feature choice. It requires governance, monitoring, and auditable processes, which become more feasible once the platform reaches sustainable profitability and can fund these capabilities at scale [\[13\]\[14\]](#).

3. What changes with agentic AI

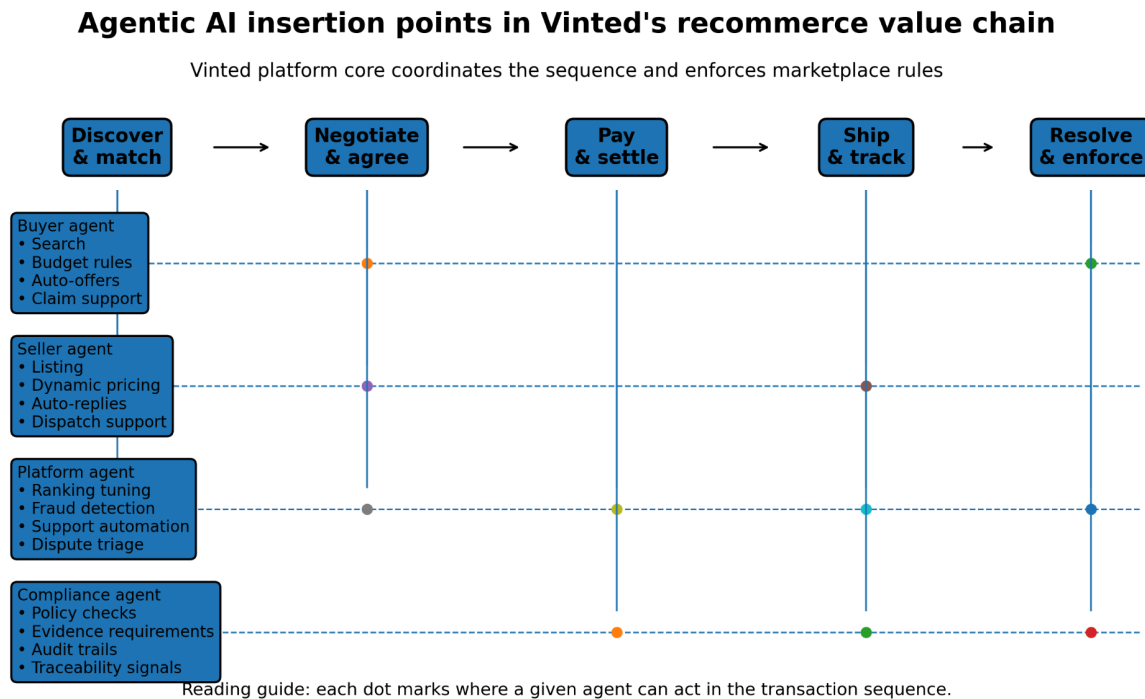


Figure 1 - Agentic AI insertion points

3.1 Definition: agentic means act, negotiate, transact

In this paper, agentic AI refers to AI systems that do more than generate content or recommendations. They can pursue goals, take actions, and coordinate with humans, platforms, or other agents through sequences of decisions, consistent with multi-agent systems logic [\[10\]](#).

From the course perspective, the shift from tools to agents changes digital coordination because agents can automate search, negotiation, and transaction steps, compressing time and attention costs [\[14\]](#). For Vinted, this matters because recommerce depends on frequent micro-coordination such as messaging, bargaining, condition checks, shipping choices, and claims handling [\[5\]\[14\]](#)

3.2 Where agents enter the value chain

We identify four agent roles that could enter Vinted's ecosystem:

1. Buyer agents (demand-side automation).

Buyer agents can monitor listings, negotiate, bundle purchases, optimize shipping, and initiate claims; they reduce search and bargaining costs but can also scale opportunism if incentives are misaligned [\[5\]\[9\]](#).

2. Seller agents (supply-side optimization).

Seller agents optimize listings, dynamically adjust prices, and respond instantly; as actors become better at optimizing rules, governance must adapt to preserve quality and fairness [\[7\]](#).

3. Platform agents (internal orchestration).

Vinted itself can automate ranking, customer support, dispute triage, and fraud detection, pushing coordination further inside the platform and strengthening centralized orchestration [\[5\]\[7\]](#).

4. Compliance agents (rules, evidence, and auditability).

Compliance agents focus on generating or verifying evidence, identity signals, traceability information, and audit logs; as automation increases, explainability and auditable enforcement become more important in Europe [\[14\]](#).

3.3 Why this threatens or strengthens the platform

Agentic AI creates a strategic fork for Vinted that we will formalize in Section 4 scenarios:

A) Disintermediation risk (agents bypass platforms).

If buyer and seller agents can search, negotiate, and transact across multiple marketplaces, they can reduce dependence on any single platform and shift value toward interoperable identity, payment, and trust rails [\[3\]\[7\]\[10\]](#). In this case, platforms lose some control over discovery and pricing, and multi-homing becomes easier, weakening lock-in and data advantage [\[5\]\[9\]](#).

B) Reinforced centralization (platform wins by owning “trust rails”)

Conversely, if Vinted integrates agents into its own workflows (listing, negotiation, checkout, dispute resolution), automation can increase conversion and retention while deepening platform control over the transaction layer [\[7\]\[14\]](#). In platform terms, embedding agents can amplify network and data feedback loops, strengthening the platform’s cumulative advantage [\[5\]\[9\]](#).

C) A governance escalation (agents raise the cost of “being open”)

Agentic automation can scale both legitimate activity and abuse (spam listings, exploitative negotiation, automated claims), raising the strategic value of enforceable rules and auditable decision processes [\[10\]\[14\]](#). This makes governance capacity

(verification, evidence standards, appeals, moderation) a core differentiator rather than a back-office cost [\[5\]\[9\]](#).

4. Future scenarios

We use a 2×2 matrix built on two uncertainties highlighted in platform and ecosystem research: (1) whether coordination remains platform-centered or shifts toward decentralized agent-to-agent exchange, and (2) whether recommerce operates on high-trust infrastructure or stays low-trust [\[5\]\[7\]\[9\]\[14\]](#). The EU push for traceability, including the Digital Product Passport logic under the ESPR, helps specify what “high-trust infrastructure” can mean in Europe [\[11\]\[12\]](#). Agentic AI is central because autonomous agents scale actions such as negotiation, optimization, and claims, increasing both efficiency and adversarial behavior [\[10\]\[14\]](#). Table 2 and Figure 3 summarize the four scenarios and their plausibility in the EU context.

4.1 Scenario A - AI Augmented Vinted

Vinted remains the central coordinator by embedding agentic capabilities inside its marketplace and strengthening its trust rails so transactions become more predictable (settlement logic, delivery evidence, dispute resolution). Agents increase conversion and reduce coordination costs, but the platform keeps control of the transaction layer because rules and evidence standards are enforced within a unified workflow. Value capture comes from the rails and governance rents: users accept fees because the platform makes exchange safer and repeatable at scale [\[5\]\[7\]\[9\]\[14\]](#).

Main risks are perceived unfairness and opaque automated decisions, which make auditability and explainability a strategic requirement in Europe. Early indicators include agent features inside the app (assisted listing, negotiation, claim triage), stronger audit logs, and proof flows tied to payments and logistics events [\[7\]\[14\]](#).

4.2 Scenario B - Open Agent Ecosystem

Vinted partially opens while preserving governance. Certified third-party agents operate through platform APIs to provide advanced services (cross-search, automated negotiation, portfolio selling), but access is conditional on testing, rate limits, logging, and sanctions [\[3\]\[7\]\[14\]](#).

Coordination becomes platform-orchestrated rather than purely platform-internal: Vinted still defines the rulebook and trust standards, while complementors innovate on top. Value capture expands to “ecosystem rents” via certification, premium access, and governed distribution. This scenario only works if enforcement is credible; otherwise, quality deteriorates quickly as agents exploit weak controls. Early indicators are public “agent APIs” with clear certification processes, anti-spam

governance for automation, and compliance reporting designed for automated actors. [\[3\]\[7\]\[14\]](#)

4.3 Scenario C - Protocolized Re-commerce

Coordination shifts toward multi-venue agent operation. Buyer and seller agents treat Vinted as one venue among several, optimizing where to transact based on fees, speed, and risk, which increases multi-homing and weakens platform-specific lock-in [\[9\]\[14\]](#). Trust becomes more portable but uneven. In some categories, traceability signals can strengthen verification; in others, condition and authenticity remain difficult to prove reliably, keeping disputes high [\[11\]\[12\]](#).

Governance fragments as multiple actors compete to define “what counts as proof” (identity, verification, settlement, arbitration), and value migrates from the marketplace interface toward the infrastructure layer that provides portable reputation and verification. The main risk is user confusion from conflicting evidence standards, especially in subjective second-hand categories. Early indicators include growth of cross-listing and cross-shopping agents, less reliance on marketplace UIs, and the emergence of standardized evidence formats across venues [\[5\]\[8\]\[14\]](#).

4.4 Scenario D - Fragmented Gray Market

Agentic AI accelerates adversarial behavior faster than governance can adapt: automated scams, synthetic listings, refund abuse, and identity manipulation scale, degrading trust and pushing exchanges into informal channels [\[5\]\[7\]\[10\]\[14\]](#). Platforms respond with friction (stricter controls, more verification), raising costs for legitimate users; liquidity drops as buyers disengage, sellers multi-home or exit, and disputes overwhelm support [\[5\]\[7\]\[10\]](#).

Regulatory pressure rises, but enforcement also displaces some activity into less regulated spaces, creating a shadow ecosystem. Value shifts away from mainstream platforms toward informal channels, while legitimate platforms face rising governance costs and reputational damage. Early indicators are spikes in dispute volumes and scam reports, heavier onboarding checks, and user migration to off-platform coordination [\[5\]\[7\]\[14\]](#).

Dimension	(A) AI-Augmented Vinted	(B) Open Agent Ecosystem	(C) Protocolized Re-commerce	(D) Fragmented Gray Market
Coordination locus	Platform-centered	Platform-orchestrated ecosystem	Multi-venue agent coordination	Fragmented, informal
Trust infrastructure	High (platform-owned + auditable)	High (standards + audits)	Mixed/uneven; trust shifts to rails	Low; arms race dominates
Value capture	Rails + governance rents	Rails + certification + ecosystem rents	Trust/identity/verification providers	Informal channels; platforms lose rents

Governance model	Strong centralized enforcement	Standards, audits, sanctions	Multiple rule systems	Reactive clampdowns
Main risks	Opacity, perceived unfairness	Quality collapses if governance is weak	Conflicting proofs; user confusion	Liquidity collapse; reputational damage
Likely winners	Vinted, high-quality sellers, convenience-seeking buyers	Agent innovators, advanced users, Vinted (if governance works)	Trust-rail providers, aggregators, power users	Scammers (short term), shadow markets
2030 plausibility in EU (our view)	High	Medium–high	Medium	Low–medium (as a pressure scenario)

Table 2 - Scenario comparison

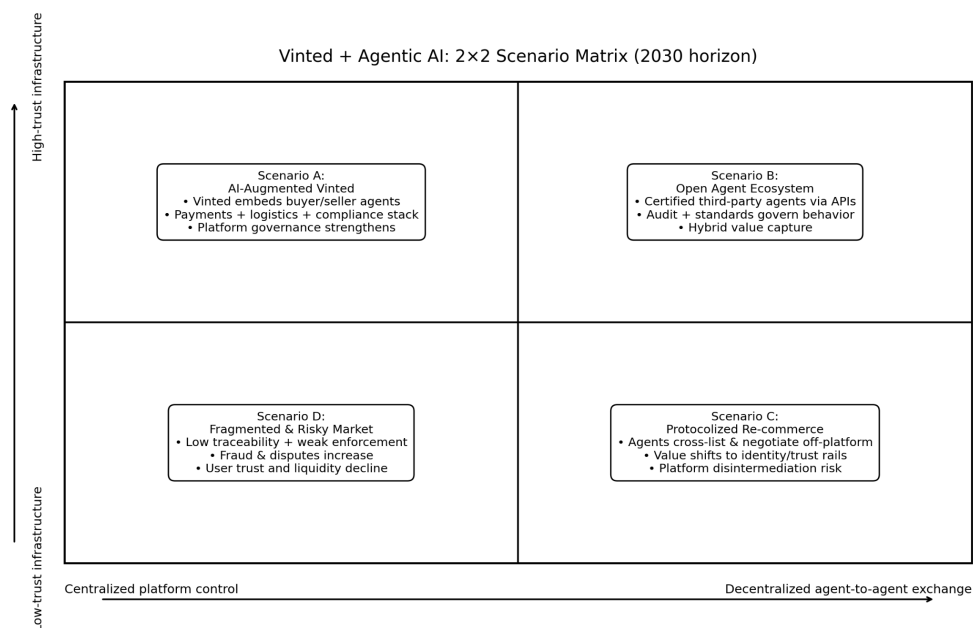


Figure 2 - Scenario map

5. Trust, traceability, and the Digital Product Passport

5.1 The DPP as a “trust substrate” for recommerce

In second-hand marketplaces, trust is the condition for liquidity. Buyers face uncertainty about authenticity, condition, provenance, and delivery or return evidence, while sellers face uncertainty about opportunistic claims. This is why marketplaces invest in governance mechanisms such as rules, verification, and dispute resolution to reduce transaction costs and stabilize repeated exchange [\[5\]\[9\]](#).

The EU Ecodesign for Sustainable Products Regulation (ESPR) extends this logic by introducing the Digital Product Passport (DPP) as a standardized information layer for products placed on the EU market. The DPP is framed as a digital identity for products, designed to support sustainability, circularity, and legal compliance [\[11\]](#).

For recommerce, the key point is that the DPP is meant to be interoperable and machine-readable: it links a product to a persistent unique identifier via a data carrier, relies on open standards, and is structured to be searchable, transferable, and machine-readable where relevant [\[11\]\[12\]](#).

This matters for Vinted because it reframes “trust” from *platform-specific* signals (ratings, buyer protection, internal dispute rules) into *product-level* verifiable information that can travel across contexts, potentially across marketplaces [\[12\]](#). In the course framing, this is exactly how “trust technologies” can enable more decentralized forms of organizing and exchange (when verification becomes cheaper and more standardised). [\[14\]](#)

Finally, textiles/apparel are explicitly highlighted as priority products in the Commission’s 2025-2030 working plan under ESPR, indicating that clothing-related ecodesign requirements and associated information infrastructures are a strategic policy focus.

5.2 How agentic AI consumes and produces trust signals

Agentic AI changes the trust problem because agents can (i) read trust signals at scale and (ii) generate actions at scale (negotiation, purchase, claims), moving from “recommendation” to “decision and action” [\[10\]\[14\]](#).

How agents will consume DPP data (trust consumption):

- Pre-purchase verification: A buyer agent can instantly check composition/material claims, certifications, compliance flags, care/repair guidance, and product model identifiers, reducing information asymmetry before purchase [\[11\]\[12\]](#).
- Counterfeit screening: When a DPP/unique identifier exists, agents can treat “passport present + consistent identifier + valid access path” as a high-weight signal, and downgrade listings with missing/inconsistent data [\[11\]\[12\]](#).

How agents will produce trust signals (trust production):

- Automated listing augmentation: seller agents can propose structured item descriptions that align with DPP fields, improving comparability across listings.
- Automated “evidence bundles” for disputes: agents can compile time-stamped photos, delivery tracking, chat logs, and passport data to support/contest claims, accelerating dispute resolution but also increasing the volume and standardization of claims.

Where risk increases, automation can industrialize fraud if verification is weak. This pushes Vinted toward standardized verification and auditable workflows rather than ad hoc moderation, consistent with the idea that governance becomes more valuable as coordination technologies scale interactions [\[5\]\[9\]\[14\]](#).

Practical constraint for Vinted (transition problem): for years, much of Vinted’s inventory will be “legacy items” without a DPP. This creates a two-tier trust environment:

- Passport-present items (newer goods) where verification can be semi-automated.
- Passport-absent items (older/fast-fashion/long-tail) where trust still depends on platform governance and evidence handling.

Strategically, Vinted can treat DPP as an upgrade path: when a passport exists, verification becomes cheaper; when it does not, Vinted must supply governance and, potentially, paid verification services.

DPP / traceability element	Recommerce trust use case (Vinted)	Agentic AI action
Persistent unique product identifier + data carrier	Reduce counterfeits; reduce “wrong item” disputes	Auto-check identifier consistency; flag anomalies; prefer passport-present listings
Material/composition + care/repair info	Better condition assessment and longevity expectations	Recommend price/quality trade-offs; propose repair pathways; reduce returns
Compliance/conformity information	Reduce legal and safety risk for certain product categories	Auto-filter risky listings; propose compliant alternatives
Interoperable, machine-readable fields	Comparability across listings/markets	Cross-market matching; standardized listing templates; automated negotiation

Table 3 - DPP data → recommerce trust use cases → agentic AI actions

5.3 Where blockchain helps and where it doesn’t

The ESPR does not mandate blockchain; it explicitly supports a decentralised data system with interoperability requirements and a registry for unique identifiers, which can be implemented with multiple architectures [\[12\]](#).

A useful framing is: blockchain is valuable when many parties must write data, and you need tamper-evidence without trusting a single operator, but it can be costly and unnecessary if a governance framework and standard auditing already exist [\[4\]](#). In DPP terms:

Where blockchain/ledgers can help

- Multi-actor write access (manufacturers, certifiers, repairers) where integrity and non-repudiation matter.
- Cross-border/cross-platform verification where actors do not share a single trusted database.

Where blockchain is likely not the bottleneck

- Data quality at the source: a tamper-proof record can still contain false inputs (“garbage in, garbage forever”). The real issue becomes certification, auditing, and liability rules, governance [\[5\]\[7\]](#).
- Performance and usability: recommerce needs cheap, fast verification at listing and checkout; heavy architectures that raise costs can reduce adoption.

The practical conclusion for Vinted is therefore not “use blockchain”, but “design for verifiability”: integrate reliable identifier checks, treat the DPP as a standardized trust layer where available, and invest in auditability and dispute-proof workflows that remain valuable in agentic commerce [\[5\]\[9\]\[14\]](#).

6. Regulation and ethical challenges in Europe

Agentic AI in recommerce will not evolve in a “regulation-free” environment. In the EU, platform governance duties, AI accountability rules, and data-sharing frameworks increasingly define what is technically feasible *and* legally sustainable (centralized orchestration vs. decentralized agent-to-agent exchange). In scenario terms, regulation becomes a design constraint and, potentially, a strategic asset for platforms that can translate compliance into auditable trust infrastructure [\[5\]\[7\]\[14\]](#).

6.1 Digital Services Act: marketplace duties, transparency, and scalable harms

The Digital Services Act (DSA) imposes harmonised due diligence obligations on online platforms that are particularly relevant for recommerce marketplaces exposed to counterfeits and other illegal listings [\[15\]](#). In practice, DSA compliance strengthens three requirements that become more demanding under agentic AI:

- (i) robust notice-and-action processes to identify and remove illegal content at scale
- (ii) transparency and procedural safeguards around moderation decisions

(iii) an increased expectation of proactive risk management for large platforms, as harmful activity can become rapidly scalable through automation [\[15\]](#).

As a result, when agents accelerate listing creation and claims, the strategic advantage shifts toward platforms able to operationalize governance through auditable workflows and consistent enforcement—supporting liquidity by reducing transaction risk in two-sided markets [\[5\]\[9\]\[14\]](#).

6.2 EU AI Act: accountability by role (provider vs deployer) and agentic decision risks

The EU AI Act introduces a risk-based framework and assigns obligations depending on whether an actor is a provider (develops/places an AI system on the market) or a deployer (uses it in operations) [\[16\]](#).

For Vinted, exposure depends on how agentic capabilities are implemented:

- If Vinted offers its own internal agents for listing, negotiation, or dispute handling, it moves closer to provider duties.
- If Vinted integrates third-party models within workflows, it remains mainly a deployer but must still manage automated decision risks [\[16\]](#).

Two issues are especially sensitive in agentic commerce:

1. Human oversight and responsibility: Agents not only “recommend”, but they can act (negotiate, purchase, trigger claims). This raises accountability risks when decisions harm users (e.g., systematic unfair refunds, automated denial of legitimate claims). The AI Act’s logic is to prevent uncontrolled autonomy through governance requirements appropriate to risk [\[16\]](#).
2. Transparency when users interact with AI systems: When users negotiate or resolve disputes through AI interfaces, transparency requirements become salient (users should not be misled about whether they are dealing with a human or an AI system) [\[16\]](#). In practice, Vinted should design disclosures, escalation paths, and auditable interaction logs.

6.3. Data Act and Data Governance Act: interoperability, access rules, and “data sovereignty”

The Data Act focuses on fair access to and use of data and promotes interoperability, particularly in contexts where data access can create market power or lock-in. Even if Vinted is not an IoT manufacturer, this becomes relevant in a DPP-enabled environment because recommerce value increasingly depends on access to standardized product information and verification signals that agents can consume at scale [\[11\]\[12\]\[17\]](#). The Data Governance Act (DGA) complements this by establishing governance mechanisms to facilitate trustworthy data sharing [\[18\]](#).

In scenario terms, these frameworks can enable interoperability while also constraining uncontrolled data extraction. This aligns with the course framing of data circulation and trust infrastructures as key drivers of new organizing forms [14].

6.4. Competition boundary condition: DMA and gatekeeper layers

The Digital Markets Act (DMA) primarily constrains designated gatekeepers, so it is unlikely to apply directly to Vinted, but it can still shape agentic commerce indirectly through control points such as app distribution, identity, and payments [19]. Even if recommerce becomes more agent-to-agent, power can re-centralize at these bottleneck layers, which is why DMA is treated as a boundary condition for the scenarios [3][7][14][19].

Regulation	What it targets	What it forces Vinted (and agents) to do	Why it matters for the scenarios
Digital Services Act (DSA) [15]	Online intermediaries/ platform duties	Notice-and-action procedures; transparency around moderation; risk management logic for large platforms	Favors auditable governance → strengthens “AI-Augmented Vinted” where compliance becomes infrastructure
AI Act [16]	AI accountability (risk-based)	If Vinted <i>provides</i> agents: stronger provider duties; if it <i>deploys</i> AI: governance/oversight + transparency obligations	Penalizes opaque automation; pushes toward human oversight + logging in negotiation/dispute agents
Data Act [17]	Fair access/use of data + interoperability	Promotes interoperability and constrains unfair data lock-in arrangements	Enables cross-platform comparability → supports hybrid/decentralized scenarios <i>if</i> access rails are open
Data Governance Act (DGA) [18]	Trust framework for data sharing	Supports trusted data intermediaries/data-sharing governance	Makes federated trust/data ecosystems more governable; constrains uncontrolled agent data harvesting
Digital Markets Act (DMA) [19]	Gatekeeper power in core platform services	Gatekeepers must follow interoperability/fairness constraints	Even if marketplaces decentralize, power can re-centralize at OS/payment/identity layers

Table 4 - Regulation mapping for Vinted under agentic AI (EU lens)

7. Critical conclusion

7.1. Most plausible 2030 scenario in Europe

Across the four scenarios, the most plausible European outcome by around 2030 is Scenario A (AI-Augmented Vinted), with a limited and governed opening toward certified third-party agents (a constrained version of Scenario B). The main reason is that, in recommerce, trust and compliance constraints scale faster than pure matching advantages, so auditable infrastructure becomes a decisive asset.

First, recommerce is structurally trust-intensive. In two-sided markets, governance is part of the value proposition because it lowers transaction costs and stabilizes participation [\[5\]\[9\]](#).

Second, agentic AI increases interaction volume, which raises the value of enforceable rules, evidence standards, and contestable decisions [\[10\]\[14\]](#).

Third, EU regulation and traceability dynamics (including DPP-like signals where available) push platforms toward logging, explainability, and verification workflows that are easier to operationalize in a platform-owned trust stack than in fully decentralized agent-to-agent exchange [\[11\]\[12\]\[15\]\[16\]](#).

7.2 Strategic recommendations for Vinted

Recommendation 1 - Build “trust rails” as core infrastructure (not features).

Vinted should treat trust as an infrastructure layer: standardized evidence bundles for disputes (photos + tracking + timestamps), counterfeit screening workflows, and clear audit trails for automated decisions. This directly supports DSA-style accountability [\[15\]](#) and reduces the risk that agentic automation turns disputes into a high-frequency failure mode [\[10\]\[16\]](#). It also strengthens liquidity by lowering perceived transaction risk [\[5\]\[9\]](#).

Recommendation 2 - Integrate DPP verification into listing and checkout where available.

Where items have DPP identifiers, Vinted should provide “passport-assisted listing” and “passport verification checks” that generate strong trust signals to buyers [\[11\]\[12\]](#). This improves comparability, reduces misrepresentation, and makes disputes more resolvable with objective data. Over time, this can become a premium trust tier for categories exposed to counterfeit risk.

Recommendation 3 - Deploy agentic AI with explicit governance: permissions, rate limits, and accountability.

Agentic features should operate under a platform “agent policy”: what actions an agent can take (post, negotiate, buy, claim), at what rate, with what authentication, and with what logging.

This is the platform equivalent of moving from open interaction to governed interaction, key for managing generativity without losing control [\[7\]\[14\]](#).

Recommendation 4 - Offer a controlled “Agent API program” rather than unmanaged openness.

To benefit from innovation without enabling disintermediation, Vinted can open APIs to certified third-party agents under audit rules. This follows the logic that openness can accelerate ecosystem value, but only if governance mechanisms prevent quality collapse and fraud scaling [\[3\]\[7\]](#).

Recommendation 5 - Defend the transaction layer (payments + logistics + identity).

In agentic commerce, value capture shifts toward the rails that make transactions enforceable. Vinted should keep strengthening integrated payments and logistics proof flows, because they generate the verifiable signals agents will use (tracking events, delivery confirmation, refund triggers). This reduces multi-homing and makes Vinted harder to bypass even if discovery becomes cross-platform [\[5\]\[14\]](#).

7.3. Final position

Agentic AI is unlikely to eliminate platforms in recommerce. It is more likely to increase the value of governance and trust infrastructure. Under EU regulation and emerging traceability standards, the actor that combines agentic automation, auditable trust rails, and interoperable product-level verification will remain central. For Vinted, the strategic objective is to become the trusted transaction and governance layer for agentic recommerce, opening selectively to external agents while preserving accountability, consumer protection, and platform liquidity [\[3\]\[5\]\[7\]\[9\]\[14\]\[15\]\[16\]](#).

8. Appendix - Use of GenAI log

8.1 Tools and models used

- Tools used: ChatGPT and Google Gemini.
- Models: GPT-5.2 (ChatGPT) and Gemini Pro 3 (Gemini).
- Period of use: January 2026, across two working sessions.

8.2 Purpose and scope of GenAI use

GenAI was used as a writing and structuring assistant and as a support tool for specific deliverables, not as a substitute for the project's intellectual work. Concretely, we used GenAI for:

- Rewriting and improving English style (clarity, concision, avoiding repetition).
- Structuring sections to align with the course expectations.
- Locating professional/institutional references, for example, support for company/institution sources (e.g., the type of source used for [\[13\]](#)).
- Generating visual figures used in the paper (scenario matrix, agentic AI insertion points), in order to communicate the argument more effectively.

8.3 Principal prompts used

1. **Rewriting and alignment with criteria**

Prompt: "Here is our first paragraph, please rewrite it in a proper way and take into consideration the criteria and expectations of the project."

2. **Scenario matrix (2×2) figure generation**

Prompt: "With the next information, you can recreate an image that will do a matrix that represents what we want to show as Scenario matrix (2×2)."

Used in: [Section 4](#) (scenario matrix figure).

3. **Agentic AI insertion points figure**

Prompt: "With the next definition, and taking into account the document that I uploaded to you, I want you to recreate the insertion point in Vinted recommerce chain value."

Used in: [Section 3](#) (Agentic AI insertion points figure).

4. **Scenario summaries and comparison table**

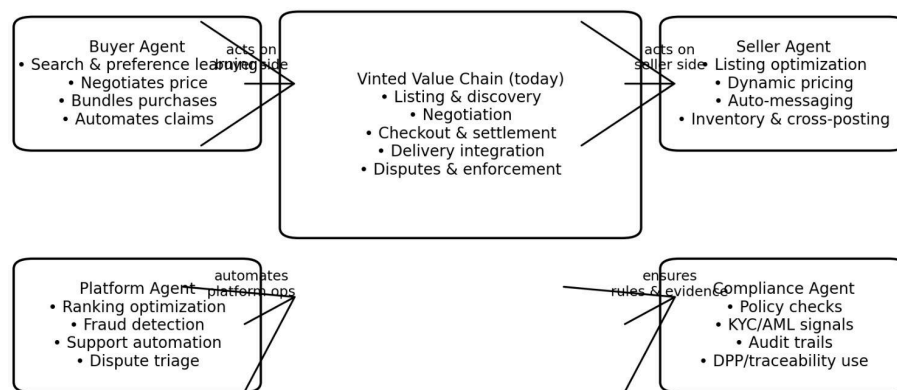
Prompt: "We have the next 4 scenarios. I want you to resume each one and generate a table to put it in a document with the important information of each scenario; also, don't forget the plausibility levels (A high, B medium-high, C medium, D low-medium)."

Used in: [Section 4](#) (scenario write-ups + scenario comparison table).

8.4 What was accepted vs. what was rejected/edited

Rejected or revised outputs

- Unsatisfactory image outputs (formatting or layout issues). We iterated until labels and placement were correct and usable in an academic report.



- Overly long paragraphs that did not fit the page constraint or the assignment objectives; we requested shorter and more objective writing.

Accepted outputs

- Language improvement and rephrasing to ensure clear academic English and eliminate redundancy.
- Consistency improvements (e.g., correcting repeated ideas and helping identify numbering issues in figures/tables).
- Final figure generation (scenario matrix and other visuals) after iterations.
- Support in identifying and formatting professional/institutional sources used in the bibliography.

8.5 Verification and quality-control approach

To reduce the risk of hallucinated or inaccurate statements:

- We performed an accuracy check using Gemini Pro 3, providing the full project, course materials, and assignment requirements, and asking for a consistency and plausibility review.
- We ensured that regulatory and institutional claims were supported by citations (EU regulations and European Commission sources).

- We manually reviewed the document to ensure the argument remained consistent with platform theory and course concepts.

8.6 Student vs. AI role delineation

The student led the project: selecting the case (Vinted), defining the problematic and scenario logic, choosing the axes of uncertainty, and deciding which arguments and references to keep. GenAI acted as a supervisor/editor tool: improving English writing, reducing repetition, helping structure sections, assisting with figure creation, and suggesting potential sources that were then checked and integrated under the student's responsibility.

Références

- [1] Bardhi, F., & Eckhardt, G. M. (2012). Access-based consumption: The case of car sharing. *Journal of Consumer Research*, 39(4), 881–898.
- [2] Belk, R. (2014). You are what you can access: Sharing and collaborative consumption online. *Journal of Business Research*, 67(8), 1595–1600.
- [3] Boudreau, K. J. (2010). Open platform strategies and innovation: Granting access vs. devolving control. *Management Science*, 56(10), 1849–1872.
- [4] Catalini, C., & Gans, J. S. (2016). Some simple economics of the blockchain (NBER Working Paper No. 22952). National Bureau of Economic Research.
- [5] de Reuver, M., Sørensen, C., & Basole, R. C. (2018). The digital platform: A research agenda. *Journal of Information Technology*, 33(2), 124–135.
- [6] Dekhili, S., Achabou, M. A., & Nguyen, T.-P. (2025). When the pro-ecological intentions of second-hand platforms backfire: The case of Vinted. *Journal of Cleaner Production*.
- [7] Gawer, A., & Cusumano, M. A. (2014). Industry platforms and ecosystem innovation. *Journal of Product Innovation Management*, 31(3), 417–433.
- [8] Guiot, D., & Roux, D. (2010). A second-hand shoppers' motivation scale: Antecedents, consequences, and implications for retailers. *Journal of Retailing*, 86(4), 355–371.
- [9] Rochet, J.-C., & Tirole, J. (2003). Platform competition in two-sided markets. *Journal of the European Economic Association*, 1(4), 990–1029.
- [10] Wooldridge, M. (2009). *An introduction to multiagent systems* (2nd ed.). Wiley.
- [11] European Commission. (2024). *Ecodesign for Sustainable Products Regulation (ESPR) and Digital Product Passport (policy overview)*.
- [12] European Union. (2024). *Regulation (EU) 2024/1781 of the European Parliament and of the Council establishing a framework for ecodesign requirements for sustainable products (ESPR)*.
- [13] Vinted Group. (2024). *Vinted Group reports 2023 results (revenue and profitability milestone)*.
- [14] Isaac, H. (2025). *Information Systems & Organization — course slides (sessions on platform model; future of platforms; decentralization; agentic organization)*.
- [15] Regulation (EU) 2022/2065. *Digital Services Act (DSA)*.
- [16] Regulation (EU) 2024/1689. *Artificial Intelligence Act*.
- [17] Regulation (EU) 2023/2854. *Data Act*.
- [18] Regulation (EU) 2022/868. *Data Governance Act*.
- [19] Regulation (EU) 2022/1925. *Digital Markets Act (DMA)*